A-Atin made by Atin

TEACHERS ONLY: lesson page / report a problem (Comments)

Too Cold to Learn: Complaint Emails

All levels (E1–L1) · PC room · about 2 hours · Teacher Plan · Version 2

Lesson page: https://claude.ai/artifact/6w2r2YAcvdrXd1qJV1UCtb

Aims

- Read and compare two complaint emails: polite and factual vs. rude and vague.
- Recognise formal and polite language. Correct common grammar mistakes in emails.
- Plan and write a clear, polite complaint email with facts, effects and a request. Check a partner's email.
- Use Outlook to send a real email (optional) to the college managers about the heating.

ESB links: Writing (format, register, paragraphs, accuracy). Reading (purpose, main points, referencing, vocabulary in context). S&L (discussion, giving opinions).

Before the lesson

- Share the lesson page with the class (Teams General channel) and put it on the projector.
- Upload the Kahoot file (import from spreadsheet). If you can, bring a thermometer: a real reading makes the emails much stronger.
- Write on the board: To: Katie.Stafford@NCCLondon.ac.uk · Cc: Jennie.Turner@… and Sarah.Wall@… (these are already filled in on the page).
- Check learners can sign in to Outlook on the web with their college account.

Stages

Min	Stage (page tab)	What happens	Interaction
10	Settle-in / 1 Warm up	Late arrivals log in. Learners click the temperature words from coldest to hottest.	Individual
8	1 Warm up	Pair talk (questions change by level). Feedback: elicit freezing, shivering, concentrate, absent.	Pairs → class
8	2 Our facts	Teacher leads on the projector. Agree the room, days, since when, temperature and effects. Learners type them; the facts fill their email frames later.	Class
15	3 Read	Each learner chooses a level. Read Email A and B; answer 5 questions (instant feedback). Class: why is B better? Board the features: greeting, who, what, when, effect, request, polite ending.	Individual → class
8	4 Polite?	Sort 6 phrases: ✓ good / × not good. Discuss: why do rude emails get the reply 'Your comments have been noted'?	Individual → class
12	5 Fix	Click the mistake in 5 sentences. Go through the language bank on the projector.	Individual
8	Kahoot	14 questions: email language, past simple / present perfect, register.	Class
25	6 Write	E1/E2: gap-fill frame. E3: 4 paragraphs, 80–120 words. L1: 5 paragraphs, 120–180 words. The live checklist turns green. Teacher circulates; spend time with E1.	Individual
8	7 Partner check	Swap seats. Read the partner's email, tick the 8 points, write one thing to change. Swap back and edit.	Pairs
8	8 Send	Optional. Open Outlook (To, Cc and Subject are filled in), check, send, check Sent Items. Optional: complaints form.	Individual
5	Review	Hangman Paragraphs game (atinwix.github.io/Hangman-Paragraphs-Game) with E2 Email B as the paragraph. Recap the 7 features.	Class

Differentiation

- **E1:** frame with drop-downs: name, room, clothes, effect. Pair a weaker E1 with a stronger E1 for sign-in and sending.

- **E2:** frame with past simple gaps (was / were / wore). Fast finishers move to E3.
- **E3:** paragraph prompts with phrase chips; present perfect focus (have been / have stopped).
- **L1:** formal register, evidence (HSE: indoor workplaces normally at least 16°C), balance ('I understand… However…'), request with a timescale. Extension: draft a polite follow-up for two weeks' time.

Classroom version (no PCs)

Use the page on the projector only, and print the Classroom Writing Frames. Print only the levels you need: one side per learner.

- **Warm up, Read, Polite?, Fix:** whole class on the projector. You click; learners answer with A–D vote cards or mini whiteboards.
- **Kahoot:** on phones, as normal.
- **Write:** on the paper frame (1 Our facts, 2 Write). Learners with smartphones can open the page link and use the Write tab instead.
- **Partner check:** part 3 on the frame.
- **Send:** learners type their email into Outlook on their phone (college account), or send it in their next PC session. Learners with the page on their phone can use the Outlook button.

Important: sending is the learners' choice

Tell learners clearly: they may send, or just keep their email. They write their own words and use their own names. Don't send on anyone's behalf. Polite, factual emails from many learners are the most effective and the hardest to dismiss.

Follow-up (about 2 weeks later)

If there's no proper reply, teach an escalation email. Refer to the date of the first emails and the number of complaints, ask again for a date, and Cc Gerry McDonald (Group Principal & CEO). Learners who used the complaints form can quote their complaint.

Answer key

Level	Read (Q1–5)	Polite? ✔ items	Fix (wrong → right)
E1	1 B (Ms Brown) · 2 A (cold) · 3 C (coats) · 4 B · 5 A (please / thank you)	Dear Ms Brown · Please fix the heating · Thank you	my→My · are→is · coat→coats · fixing→fix · amina→Amina
E2	1 B · 2 B (last week) · 3 C (hands cold) · 4 B · 5 B (rude, no details)	I am writing about… · Could you please… · Thank you for your help	is→was · wear→wore · was→were · in→about · to fix→fix
E3	1 B (complain + repair) · 2 B (some students) · 3 B (don't take off) · 4 C · 5 C (rude, threat)	I am writing to complain… · I would be grateful… · I look forward…	are→have been · to come→coming · shivered→shivering · will repaired→will be repaired · hear→hearing
L1	1 B · 2 B (representing) · 3 B (evidence) · 4 C (emotional, aggressive) · 5 B (facts + clear request)	raise a concern… · I would appreciate… · Could you let us know…	rise→raise · affect→effect · can→could · at less→at least · will take→will be taken

ROW snippet

Date: ____ | Teacher: Atin | Activities: Warm-up temperature words + pair discussion; class fact-gathering (cold classrooms); read/compare 2 complaint emails (levelled questions); polite vs rude sort; error correction; Kahoot; wrote complaint email (levelled frames); peer check; optional sending via Outlook | Notes: